

SHRSS AEMaaCS DAM & Content Operations Best Practices Volume (DAM Architects & Librarians)

SHRSS DAM & Content Operations Best Practices Volume

For DAM architects, librarians, and content operations leads

0. Role & Scope

This volume is for the people who:

- Decide **how assets are organized, tagged, and governed**.
- Ensure authors can find the right images and documents quickly.
- Keep SHRSS's DAM from drifting into "content chaos".

It builds on public guidance such as:

- [Introducing Assets as a Cloud Service for Digital Asset Management in AEM](#)
 - [Organize your digital assets](#)
 - [Manage metadata of your digital assets](#)
 - [Metadata best practices for AEM Assets](#)
 - [Taxonomy and tagging best practices for AEM Assets](#)
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1. SHRSS DAM Architecture – What You're Optimizing For

1.1 Use cases

The DAM must support:

- **Job & careers imagery:**

- People, workplace, culture, diversity stories.
- **Events & entertainment:**
 - Concerts, shows, tournaments, venue atmospheres.
- **Locations & properties:**
 - Exterior/interior shots, amenities, maps.
- **News & corporate communications:**
 - Executive portraits, logos, infographics, PDFs.

1.2 Strategic objectives

- Make it easy to answer:
 - "Find all images for Property X suitable for Job cards."
 - "Find event hero images used in the last 6 months."
 - Support **CF-based content**:
 - Every CF that references an image should point to **stable, well-managed assets**.
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2. Folder Structure & Naming

Backed by:

- [Organize your digital assets](#)

2.1 Patterns that work

At the top level for SHRSS:

- Organize by **business domain**, then **brand/property**, then **use**. For example:

```

/content/dam/shrss
  /brand
    /<brand-name>
      /logos
      /brand-guidelines
  /locations
    /<region>/<property>
      /exteriors
      /interiors
      /amenities

```

- /maps
- /jobs
 - /global
 - /by-region
- /events
 - /venue
 - /campaigns
- /news
 - /media-kits
 - /press-images

Best practices:

- Keep folder depth **2–4 levels**, not 8–10.
- Do not mix:
 - Raw photography.
 - Final web-ready images.
 - PDFs.
 - In the same catch-all folder.

2.2 Naming assets

- File names should be:
 - **Human-readable and stable:**
 - brand-logo-primary-horizontal.png
 - property-xyz-lobby-hero-2026.jpg
 - Avoid random UUIDs or internal naming from agencies; normalize on ingest.
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3. Metadata Strategy – Make Search Work for You

Anchor:

- [Manage metadata of your digital assets](#)
- [Metadata best practices for AEM Assets](#)

3.1 Core metadata fields for SHRSS

For most images:

- **Title** – human-friendly name.
- **Description** – what is this asset? context, scene, property.
- **Brand** – tag or metadata field.
- **Property / Location** – link to the property (tag or metadata).
- **Asset type** – hero, card image, background, icon, etc.
- **Usage rights / expiry** – optional but ideal.

3.2 Metadata profiles

Use **metadata profiles** to:

- Auto-apply default fields for folders:
 - Location folders:
 - Pre-fill brand and property fields.
 - Jobs imagery:
 - Mark as “careers” usage, with recommended alt text patterns.

See:

- [Metadata profiles](#)
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4. Taxonomy & Tagging – The Real Power Tool

Anchor:

- [Taxonomy and tagging best practices for AEM Assets](#)

4.1 Design stable taxonomies

Top-level namespaces you’ll likely maintain:

- `shrss:brand`
- `shrss:property`
- `shrss:asset-type`
- `shrss:audience`
- `shrss:season` (if relevant to campaigns)

Guidelines:

- Keep taxonomies **stable**. Adjust titles freely; avoid moving nodes casually.

- Avoid synonyms:
 - Choose one of casino–resort, casino, resort and stick with it.
- Think “filter facets”:
 - Tags should map to how authors will filter:
 - “Find all summer campaign assets for Brand A”.
 - “Find career imagery for Property X”.

4.2 Tagging workflows

For new assets:

1. Upload to the correct folder (with metadata profile applied).
 2. Immediately:
 - Set Title, Description.
 - Apply brand, property, asset-type tags.
 3. Add any **campaign-specific** tags as needed.
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5. Linking Assets to CFs & Pages

5.1 CFs referencing assets

Every main CF type has image fields:

- Job image.
- Event hero/card image.
- Location hero/gallery images.
- News story images.
- Promotion card images.

Operational best practices:

- Enforce a “**no CF without image**” rule where images are expected:
 - Either through model required fields.
 - Or through QA checklists.
- Prefer images from **location-specific** or **brand-specific** folders:
 - This keeps rights and look-and-feel consistent.

5.2 Replacing images safely

When an image changes:

- Prefer **replacing the binary** of an existing asset when:
 - The image usage and concept remain the same (e.g., updated logo).
- Create a **new asset** and update references when:
 - Concept changes (different scene, people, or location).

This keeps CF references intact where warranted and avoids silent visual changes when you need traceability.

6. Search & Facets for Authors

Anchor:

- [Search assets in AEM](#)
- [AEM Assets Search Best Practices](#)

6.1 Search configuration

Work with admins to:

- Enable search facets for:
 - Brand.
 - Property.
 - Asset type.
 - Campaign.
- Add **saved searches** for common tasks:
 - "Job card imagery – Brand X".
 - "Event heroes – next quarter".

6.2 Training authors

Train authors to:

- Start with **folders**, then refine with tags and facets.
 - Use metadata in search:
 - Encourage sensible Descriptions; they're searchable.
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7. Asset Lifecycle & Governance

7.1 Ingestion

- Define standard processes for:
 - Agency deliveries.
 - On-site photography.
- Require:
 - Minimal metadata on ingest.
 - Bulk metadata updates where needed.

7.2 Approval & deprecation

Rules of thumb:

- Use **collections** or dedicated folders for:
 - Approved assets for Jobs.
 - Approved assets for Events.
 - For deprecated assets:
 - Mark with a metadata flag and tag.
 - Avoid immediate deletion if:
 - Assets may still be referenced by older CFs/pages.
 - Periodically:
 - Use reports to find unreferenced assets and only then consider deletion.
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References

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- [Search assets in AEM](#)